DSAI1202 Project

Do Something Cool with AI — and Learn from It

The core idea

Use AI to try something your team genuinely wants to do — especially something that once felt difficult or even impossible for you. Then turn what actually happened into lessons about working with AI.

1. What is this project about?

Generative AI can now help us do things that previously required knowledge, skills, time, or experience we might not have. **In this project, your team will use AI to attempt something that you genuinely find interesting, useful, meaningful, or simply cool.**

"Cool" does not mean flashy, technically difficult, or visually impressive. It means something your team genuinely wants to make happen — especially something you might previously have thought was difficult or impossible.

You may use AI actively and extensively. The key question is not whether you used "a lot" or "a little" AI. The key questions are:

- What were you able to do with AI that would otherwise have been difficult?
- What did you learn about working with AI while doing it?

2. Two parts of the project

Part 1 — Do Something with AI

Choose something your team wants to attempt and use AI to help you do it. The form is intentionally open. For example, you might:

- create or build something;
- learn or understand something that has been difficult for you;
- try something creative that you previously lacked the skills to make;
- help a real person with a real need;
- investigate a question or claim;
- solve a real problem or improve something you already do;
- or do something completely different.

Your project does not have to succeed perfectly. An ambitious attempt that produces interesting failures, surprises, or lessons can also be a strong project.

Part 2 — Lessons Learned from Working with AI

While doing the project, pay attention to what actually happens when you work with AI. Your lessons may include:

- what AI was surprisingly good at;
- what AI struggled with or misunderstood;
- what you had to verify, change, or reject;
- where human knowledge, judgment, creativity, taste, or responsibility mattered;
- what should or should not be delegated to AI;
- what surprised you and how your approach changed;
- what you would do differently next time.

Your lessons should come primarily from your actual project experience. They do not need to be universal. Specific lessons from a real attempt are often more useful than generic advice about AI.

3. Schedule

Date	Time	Activity
Week 4	Lecture time	Project introduced. Start forming groups and exploring ideas.
26 September Saturday	23:59	Group formation should be confirmed. Groups should have 4–5 students.
Week 6	Lecture time	Short in-class Topic Pitch. After the pitch, teams may still refine or change their direction.
10 October Saturday	23:59	Topic fixed and submitted.
Weeks 6–10	---	Project development.
14 November Saturday	23:59	Final submission: Project Demo Video + Lessons Learned Video + Contribution Statement (and project output/link if relevant).
Week 13-14	**TBD**, hopefully the weekend of Week 13	Face-to-face team Q&A with the teaching team. No prepared presentation is required.

4. Topic pitch

Each group will briefly present its current project idea to the class. A typical pitch for each group should take about 4 minutes, with 2 minutes' presentation followed by short questions or comments from classmates.

Your pitch should answer three simple questions:

- What do you want to do?
- Why does your team find it interesting or worth trying?
- How might AI help you do something that would otherwise be difficult?

Important

The Week 6 pitch is an idea test, not a final commitment. You may refine or completely change your direction after hearing questions and seeing other groups' ideas.

5. Final submission

The team leader should submit the following items on behalf of the group. All videos should be accessible to the teaching team.

Deliverable 1 — Project Demo Video (about 5–10 minutes)

Show us what your team actually attempted and what happened. The video should make the project easy to understand even if the project output takes a form that is difficult to submit directly.

The video should cover:

- what you tried to do and why you chose it;
- how AI was used in the project;
- what you actually made, tested, investigated, learned, or experienced;
- what happened in the end, including important changes, failures, or surprises.

If your project produces an output (for example, software, a website, a game, artwork, music, a prototype, data, or another artifact), you may also submit or link to it where practical. **The video remains the main way for the teaching team to understand your project.**

Deliverable 2 — Lessons Learned from Using AI (about 5–10 minutes)

Create a short AI Fluency / Lessons Learned video based on what actually happened during your project.

Do not simply repeat general statements such as "AI can hallucinate" or "we should verify AI outputs." **Use concrete examples from your own project to explain**:

- what worked and what did not;
- what you had to verify, change, reject, or rethink;
- where human judgment and responsibility mattered;
- what your team would do differently next time.

Deliverable 3 — Contribution Statement

The team leader must also submit a short contribution statement describing the main contribution of each member. All team members should review and agree with this statement before submission.

6. Assessment — 25 marks

Component	Marks	Timing
Topic Pitch	5	Week 6
What You Did	10	Week 11
Lessons Learned from Using AI	10	Week 11
Total	**25**	

A. Topic Pitch — 5 marks

The Topic Pitch is completion-based. A group that gives a proper pitch receives the full 5 marks. We are not grading whether your topic sounds more impressive than another group's topic.

B. What You Did — 10 marks

Criterion	Marks	What we look for
Meaning and ambition of the attempt	2	The team attempts something genuinely interesting, useful, meaningful, or challenging to them. "Ambitious" does not mean technically complicated or flashy.
Real engagement with the task	3	The team actually explores the problem rather than simply producing a polished final output. **There is evidence of trying, testing, revising, comparing, or responding to what happened**.
Purposeful use of AI	2	AI is used to extend what the team can do. The team makes active choices about how AI is used rather than simply accepting whatever it generates.
Outcome / what was actually achieved	3	The team clearly demonstrates what they made, learned, tested, discovered, or accomplished. A meaningful failed attempt can also score well if the exploration is substantial.

C. Lessons Learned from Using AI — 10 marks

Criterion	Marks	What we look for
Grounded in the actual project	4	Lessons clearly come from things that actually happened during the project and are supported by concrete examples rather than generic statements about AI.
Depth of reflection	3	The team goes beyond describing what happened and explains why it happened, what they learned, and how their understanding or approach changed.
Human judgment and responsibility	3	The team identifies where human decisions, evaluation, verification, creativity, knowledge, taste, or responsibility mattered, and explains how these affected the project.

7. Final face-to-face Q&A

There is no additional prepared presentation in Week 13. The whole team should attend the Q&A. The teaching team will ask questions based on your Week 11 videos and Contribution Statement.

Questions may include but not limited to:

- Why did you make a particular decision?
- What did AI get wrong or fail to understand?
- What changed during the project, and why?
- What did you personally contribute?
- How did you verify or evaluate a particular result?

The Week 11 marks are initially group marks. The Week 13 Q&A is used to verify individual participation and understanding. Individual marks may be adjusted if there is a clear mismatch between the submitted work, the declared contribution, and a student's demonstrated understanding.

The goal of the Q&A

We are not trying to prove whether you used AI. AI use is encouraged. We want to see whether each student remained genuinely involved, understood the work, and can take responsibility for what the team submitted.

8. Some questions to spark ideas

These are examples only. Do not treat them as a topic list.

- Can AI help me finally understand something I have struggled with for years?
- Can I build something useful even though I do not know how to program?
- Can AI help us create something we previously lacked the technical skills to make?
- Can AI help us solve a real problem for someone we know?
- Can AI help us investigate whether something we often hear is actually true?
- Can AI help us learn a completely new skill faster?
- Can AI help us create something that still genuinely feels like ours?
- Can AI help us do something we previously thought was impossible for us?

A good starting question

What is something you would really like to do, understand, create, investigate, or improve if AI could help you?

Try to make something that, by the end of the semester, you are happy to say: "We made this."

9. Group formation

Each group should have no less than 4 and no more than 5 students.

Form your own team of 4–5 students.

Canvas has two separate Project Group Sets, one for each lecture class. Join only the Group Set for the lecture class you attend. **Cross-class groups are not allowed.**

To register your team in Canvas:

- go to People and open the Project Group Set for your lecture class;
- agree on one available Project Group and have all team members join the same group;
- make sure your group has 4–5 members by the group-formation deadline.

Each team should choose one team leader. This is a project role only; you do not need to set a special Canvas Group Leader. The team leader should give the Week 6 Topic Pitch, which also confirms the leader to the teaching team, and is responsible for the Week 11 final submission on behalf of the group. Generally, the team leader should not be changed after week 6. In unpredictable emergency cases, please contact me.

10. Submission of Deliverables

For the final submission, **the team leader should submit ONE PDF file on Canvas on behalf of the whole group**.

The PDF should include:

- Group number and project title
- Names of all team members
- Project Demo Video link
- Lessons Learned from Using AI Video link
- Project output / artifact link, if relevant
- Contribution Statement, briefly describing the main contribution of each team member

The two videos should normally be uploaded to **YouTube as Unlisted videos**. **Do not set the videos to Private**. The teaching team should be able to open the links directly without requesting access.

All submitted links must remain accessible to the teaching team until the end of the semester.

A suggested format is:

Group: LEC00X Group XX
Project Title: ...

Project Demo Video: [YouTube link]
Lessons Learned Video: [YouTube link]
Project Output / Artifact: [link, if applicable]

Contribution Statement
Student A — ...
Student B — ...
Student C — ...
Student D — ...

All team members have reviewed and agreed with this contribution statement.

Please name the submitted PDF: **LEC00X_groupXX_submission.pdf**